For example: Enzymes serve as catalyst for chemical reactions in cell and are non-specific. Antibodies are complex glycoproteins with specific regions of attachment for various organisms.

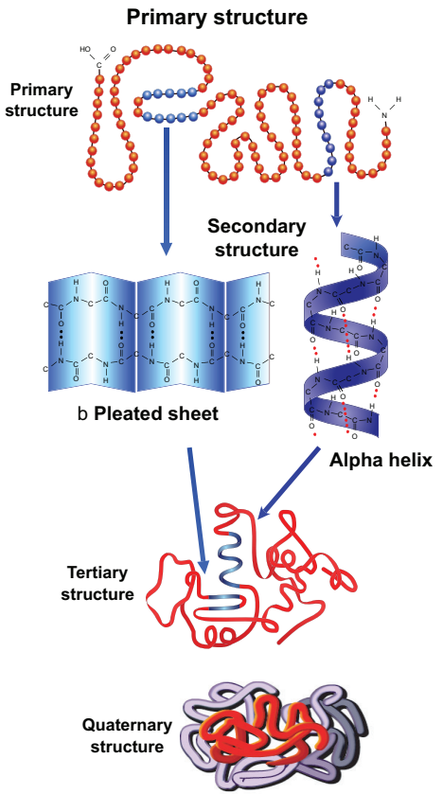


Figure 8.12: Structure of Protein

8.5.3 Protein Denaturation

Denaturation is the loss of 3D structure of protein. Exposure to heat causes atoms to vibrate violently, and this disrupts the hydrogen and ionic bonds. Under these conditions, protein molecules become elongated, disorganised strands. Agents such as soap, detergents, acid, alcohol and some disinfectants disrupt the interchain bond and cause the molecule to be non-functional (Figure 8.13).



Christian Anfinsen explained denaturation of proteins by heat treatment leading to breakage of non-covalent bond.

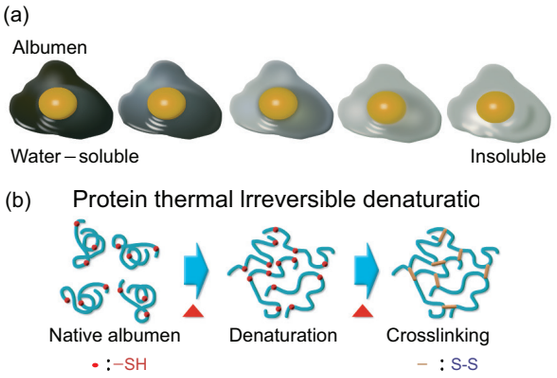


Figure 8.13: Protein denaturation

8.5.4 Protein Bonding

There are four types of chemical bonds

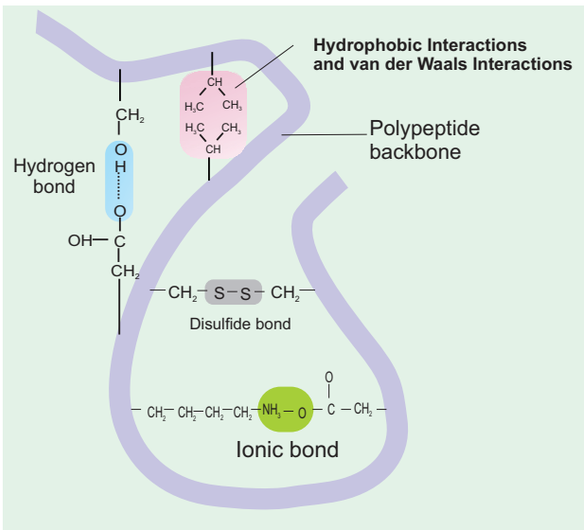


Figure 8.14: Protein bonding

Hydrogen Bond

It is formed between some hydrogen atoms of oxygen and nitrogen in polypeptide chain. The hydrogen atoms have a small positive charge and oxygen and nitrogen have small negative charge. Opposite charges attract to form hydrogen bonds.

Though these bonds are weak, large number of them maintains the molecule in 3D shape (Figure 8.14).

Ionic Bond

It is formed between any charged groups that are not joined together by peptide bond. It is stronger than hydrogen bond and can be broken by changes in pH and temperature.

XIth_BIO-BOTANY_Ch_8-EM.indd 159 5/17/2020 11:22:30 PM